

ing down,” he says. The idea that a few companies will build models for the world is changing. “AI has to be built more broadly, it has to become a shared capability, not the monopoly of a few,” he says.

Can India catch up? “We are the world’s most ingenious users of technology, focusing on real-world utility over theoretical hype,” says Nipun Kalra, India Leader, BCGX, adding that India’s edge lies in its ‘value-first’ DNA. With a projected \$17 billion market by 2027 and a massive talent pool, the real ‘secret sauce’ is the country’s diffusion rails. “Our digital public infrastructure allows us to distribute AI updates to 1.4 billion people overnight,” he says.

THE BUSINESS CASE

Having a sovereign AI model is a matter of pride. But what about use cases and business proposition? For Sarvam, the near-term opportunity lies less in consumer AI and more in enterprise and institutional deployments around large-scale human interactions.

Raghavan says the most immediate revenue pools will emerge from B2B2C (business to business to consumer) and B2G use cases, particularly in sectors that rely on large and distributed workforces.

Industries such as insurance, banking, telecom, and FMCG employ millions of field agents and sales representatives, many of whom operate in regional languages. AI tools that assist these agents—through real-time prompts, training, customer interaction support, or even partial automation—could improve productivity and conversion rates. Sarvam recently partnered with SBI Life In-

surance to deploy multilingual generative AI for enhanced customer engagement and with Tata Capital for scaling its multilingual voice AI.

Raghavan says the revenue op-

and citizen feedback, AI-powered voice interfaces can help public agencies understand citizen needs at scale. Sarvam also sees value in conversation intelligence, helping enterprises monitor how effectively their frontline teams communicate, promote products, and engage customers.

Raghavan says sovereign AI’s business case will be built not on generic chatbots, but on optimising India’s vast last-mile workforce and citizen interface ecosystem.

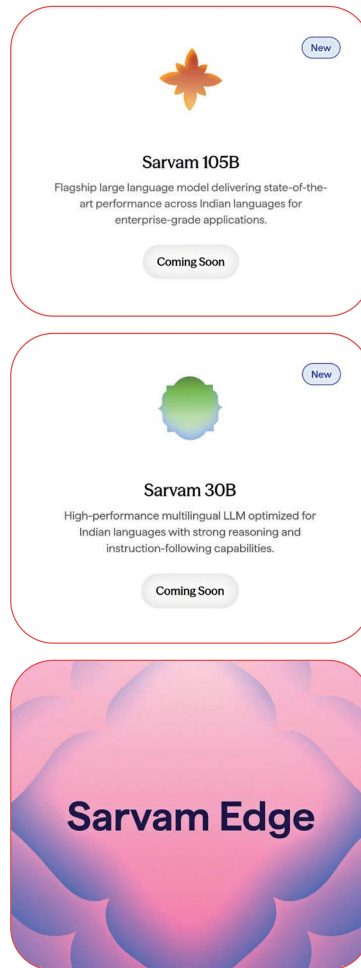
THE SCALE GAP

Compared with global peers such as ChatGPT, whose underlying models run trillions of parameters, Sarvam’s models are significantly smaller. The reasons are structural—limited access to high-end GPUs and constrained capital in a domain where frontier AI development requires billions of dollars. Yet, experts say the achievement must be viewed in context.

Jaspreet Bindra, founder of AI & Beyond, says any discussion on sovereignty must acknowledge India’s resource realities. From a sovereign foundation model perspective, India has three key efforts—Sarvam, Gnani, and BharatGen—with Sarvam emerging as the most comprehensive among them, he says. In total, five companies working under the IndiaAI Mis-

sion announced their models at the India AI Impact Summit, including Gnani.ai BharatGen, Fractal, and Tech Mahindra.

“All credit to these teams,” he says, pointing out that the Indian models have been built under severe capital, compute, and infrastructure constraints. “Developing models of this scale, with a relative-



portunity is even larger in Tier II and Tier III markets. “The final interaction in India almost always happens in voice and in a local language,” he says, pointing to AI’s potential to both assist and analyse these exchanges.

Government outreach can be another revenue source. From welfare delivery to grievance redressal